CORE FALSE BELIEF #8 · OTHER PEOPLE

“I don’t belong.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Feeling like an outsider can come from moving often, being left out at school, growing up in a family where we felt different, or being excluded because of our background, looks, or abilities. Some people felt unwanted at home or were treated as the “odd one.” Later, the belief can make us hold back in groups, read rejection into neutral situations, or leave before we can be left.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture says that in Christ we are no longer strangers and foreigners, but members of God’s household. God arranged the members of the body exactly as He wanted, and each part belongs to the others. He settles the lonely in families. Peter wrote to scattered people that they were now God’s chosen people. Belonging is not something you have to win by fitting in; it is something God gives. You may still need time and effort to find your place among people, but you already have a place in His family.

> *“Therefore you are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of God’s household”* (Ephesians 2:19).

Also see

> “But in fact, God has arranged the members of the body, every one of them, according to His design” (1 Corinthians 12:18).

> “So in Christ we who are many are one body, and each member belongs to one another” (Romans 12:5).

> “But you are a chosen people, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a people for God’s own possession, to proclaim the virtues of Him who called you out of darkness into His marvelous light. Once you were not a people, but now you are the people of God; once you had not received mercy, but now you have received mercy” (1 Peter 2:9–10).

> “God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land” (Psalm 68:6).

Common self-statements

- I never fit in anywhere.
- Everyone else has their group.
- People just tolerate me.
- I’m always on the outside looking in.
- If I speak up, they’ll see I don’t belong.
- I’m different from everyone.

Common logical errors

- Mind reading: Assuming others think I don’t belong without asking.
- Overgeneralization: Deciding I don’t belong anywhere because I felt left out somewhere.
- Personalization: Taking ordinary group dynamics as rejection of me.
- Emotional reasoning: Believing I am an outsider because I feel like one.

Challenging questions

- Where and when did I first feel I didn't belong?
- Is it true that I don't belong anywhere, or only in some places?
- What evidence is there that someone wants me around?
- Am I holding back in ways that make belonging harder?
- What does God say about my place in His family?
- Where could I begin to belong, even a little?

Truth summary

> I have felt left out, and that hurt. But I am not an outsider to God. In Christ I am a member of His household, placed in His body on purpose. I can take small steps toward people, knowing my true place is already secure.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Loneliness
- Church
- Friendship
- Chosen/Elect
- Love, For Others

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Love
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

If We Are the Body — Casting Crowns
The church is called to welcome and care for people rather than exclude or shame them.

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "I don't belong"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I don't belong." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ When did I first feel I didn't belong?
- ☐ Is it true I don't belong anywhere?
- ☐ What evidence shows someone wants me around?
- ☐ Am I holding back?
- ☐ What does God say about my place?
- ☐ Where could I begin to belong?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am a member of God's household.
- ☐ God placed me in His body on purpose.
- ☐ I belong to Christ and to His people.
- ☐ Feeling like an outsider is not the same as being one.
- ☐ Belonging grows with time and small steps.
- ☐ God settles the lonely in families.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Ephesians 2:19
  "Therefore you are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of God's household."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:18
  "But in fact, God has arranged the members of the body, every one of them, according to His design."
- ☐ Romans 12:5
  "So in Christ we who are many are one body, and each member belongs to one another."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Moments of connection: Each day, write one moment when you felt even a little connected to someone, and what helped.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Ephesians 2:19 becomes: "Tom can write: "I am not a stranger. I am a member of God's household, and I belong in His family.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Loneliness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] Show up three times. Choose one group, such as a class, Bible study, or volunteer team, and attend three times before deciding whether you belong.
- [ ] Contribute something. Offer one small help or skill in a group this week. Belonging often grows through serving together.
- [ ] Ask instead of assuming. When you sense rejection, gently check it out or wait for more evidence before concluding.
- [ ] Invite someone. Invite one person for coffee or a walk. Belonging often starts with one relationship.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I don't belong": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A moment I felt I belonged
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I don't belong.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I have felt like an outsider for so long. Thank You that in Christ I am a member of Your household. Lead me to people where I can grow roots, give me courage to show up, and help me rest in the place You have already given me. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

CORE FALSE BELIEF #9 · OTHER PEOPLE

“People will leave me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Fear of being left often begins with real loss: a parent who left, died, or was emotionally absent; a divorce; repeated moves; or a partner who walked away. A child may conclude that people always leave, and that it must be because of something in them. As adults, people with this fear may cling tightly, test others, or avoid closeness altogether, and these patterns can sometimes bring about the very loss they fear.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is honest that people do leave, die, and fail us. David even wrote of being forsaken by father and mother. But God promises He will never leave or forsake His people. Isaiah says that even if a mother could forget her nursing child, God will not forget you. Jesus promised not to leave His followers as orphans. Human relationships are precious and uncertain, but there is One who will never walk away. That security can free us to love others without clinging or running.

> *“Be strong and courageous; do not be afraid or terrified of them, for it is the LORD your God who goes with you; He will never leave you nor forsake you”* (Deuteronomy 31:6).

Also see

> “Keep your lives free from the love of money and be content with what you have, for God has said: ‘Never will I leave you, never will I forsake you.’” (Hebrews 13:5).

> “Though my father and mother forsake me, the LORD will receive me” (Psalm 27:10).

> “‘Can a woman forget her nursing child, or lack compassion for the son of her womb? Even if she could forget, I will not forget you!’” (Isaiah 49:15).

> “I will not leave you as orphans; I will come to you” (John 14:18).

Common self-statements

- Everyone I love eventually leaves.
- It’s only a matter of time.
- If I let someone close, they’ll abandon me.
- I have to keep people happy or they’ll go.
- I’m easy to walk away from.
- I can’t survive being left again.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that people will leave without evidence.
- Overgeneralization: Believing that because some people left, everyone will.
- Personalization: Assuming people left because something is wrong with me.
- Catastrophizing: Imagining that being left would be unbearable and endless.

Challenging questions

- Who left me in the past, and what were the real reasons?

- Who has stayed in my life, even through hard times?
- Am I clinging, testing, or pulling away to protect myself?
- What evidence do I have that this person will leave?
- What does God promise about His presence?
- How could I love more freely if I trusted God's presence?

Truth summary

> Some people have left me, and that was painful. But not everyone leaves, and God never will. He has promised to be with me always. I can love people without clinging or running, because my deepest security is in the One who stays.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Loneliness
- Friendship
- God, Present Everywhere
- Trust
- Fear

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Love
- Anxiety/Worry/Fear

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Softly and Tenderly — Kristyn Getty with Vince Gill, Ellie Holcomb and Sierra Hull
This older hymn pictures Christ's gracious invitation to return rather than hide in shame.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People will leave me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People will leave me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who left me, and why?
- ☐ Who has stayed?
- ☐ Am I clinging, testing, or pulling away?
- ☐ What evidence says this person will leave?
- ☐ What does God promise about His presence?
- ☐ How could I love more freely?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God will never leave or forsake me.
- ☐ God will not forget me.
- ☐ Not everyone leaves.
- ☐ My past losses do not predict every future.
- ☐ I can love without clinging.
- ☐ Jesus will not leave me an orphan.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Deuteronomy 31:6**
  "Be strong and courageous; do not be afraid or terrified of them, for it is the LORD your God who goes with you; He will never leave you nor forsake you."
- ☐ **Isaiah 49:15**
  "'Can a woman forget her nursing child, or lack compassion for the son of her womb? Even if she could forget, I will not forget you!'"
- ☐ **Psalm 27:10**
  "Though my father and mother forsake me, the LORD will receive me."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Who stayed today: Each evening, write the names of people who showed up for you today, in large or small ways.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Deuteronomy 31:6 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord goes with me. He will never leave me or forsake me.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "God, Present Everywhere" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- ☐ List the people who stayed. Write the names of people who have stayed in your life through hard times. Thank God for each one.
- ☐ Notice the test. When you are tempted to test someone's loyalty, pause and instead tell them honestly what you need.
- ☐ Practice letting go a little. Give someone space this week without texting or checking in excessively. Notice what happens.
- ☐ Rest in God's promise. Write Deuteronomy 31:6 on a card and read it whenever you fear being left.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie “People will leave me”: _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Someone who stayed
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People will leave me.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am afraid of losing the people I love. Thank You that You will never leave me or forsake me. Heal the wounds from those who left, help me love without clinging, and let me rest in Your faithful presence. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

CORE FALSE BELIEF #10 · OTHER PEOPLE

“No one will care for me when I need them.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

This belief often starts in homes where needs were ignored, dismissed, or punished, or where a child had to care for a parent instead of being cared for. Times of illness, crisis, or grief when no one showed up can deepen it. People who hold this belief often become fiercely self-reliant, never ask for help, and then feel confirmed when no one offers.

What Scripture teaches

God invites us to cast all our anxiety on Him, because He cares for us. Jesus pointed to the birds of the air and reminded us that our Father feeds them, and we are worth much more. The Lord is near to all who call on Him. Scripture also calls believers to carry one another’s burdens; caring for each other is how God designed His family to work. People may have failed you, but God cares, and He often sends His care through people when we let them in.

> *“Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you”* (1 Peter 5:7).

Also see

> “Cast your burden upon the LORD and He will sustain you; He will never let the righteous be shaken” (Psalm 55:22).

> “Look at the birds of the air: They do not sow or reap or gather into barns—and yet your heavenly Father feeds them. Are you not much more valuable than they?” (Matthew 6:26).

> “The LORD is near to all who call on Him, to all who call out to Him in truth” (Psalm 145:18).

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” (Galatians 6:2).

Common self-statements

- If I fall apart, no one will be there.
- I have to take care of myself because no one else will.
- Asking for help is pointless.
- People only show up when they need something.
- My needs are a burden to others.
- I’m on my own.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralization: Deciding that because some people didn’t care, no one will.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that no one will help before I ask.
- Discounting the positive: Overlooking times when people did help.
- Mind reading: Assuming others see my needs as a burden.

Challenging questions

- When were my needs ignored, and by whom?
- When has someone cared for me, even a little?
- Do I let people know when I need help?
- Am I so self-reliant that no one gets the chance to care?

- What does God say about His care for me?
- Who is one person I could ask for help?

Truth summary

> There were times when no one cared for me as I needed. But God cares for me, and He often sends His care through people. I can let my needs be known, ask for help, and give others the chance to show up.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Help
- Loneliness
- Friendship
- Prayer, Answers to
- God, All Loving

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Prayer
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

Jesus — Chris Tomlin
Jesus is present in suffering and is greater than the circumstances we face.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus — Keith and Kristyn Getty
This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "No one will care for me when I need them"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"No one will care for me when I need them." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ When were my needs ignored?
- ☐ When has someone cared for me?
- ☐ Do I let people know my needs?
- ☐ Am I so self-reliant that no one can help?
- ☐ What does God say about His care?
- ☐ Who could I ask for help?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God cares for me.
- ☐ I can cast my burdens on the Lord.
- ☐ My Father knows what I need.
- ☐ Asking for help is not weakness.
- ☐ God's family is meant to carry burdens together.
- ☐ The Lord is near when I call.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 1 Peter 5:7
  "Cast all your anxiety on Him, because He cares for you."
- ☐ Psalm 55:22
  "Cast your burden upon the LORD and He will sustain you; He will never let the righteous be shaken."
- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Care I received: Each day, write one way someone cared for you, or one time you asked for help and what happened.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 Peter 5:7 becomes: "Karen can write: "I can give my worries to God, because He cares for me.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Help" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- ☐ Make a help list. Write the names of people you could call in a hard moment, even if you have never asked. Add a church or helpline.
- ☐ Ask for something small. Ask one person for a small, specific favor this week. Note how they responded.
- ☐ Tell someone how you are. When asked "How are you?" give one honest answer instead of "Fine."
- ☐ Pray your needs. Each morning, tell God one specific need, following 1 Peter 5:7.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "No one will care for me when I need them": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A time someone cared
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~No one will care for me when I need them.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I have felt alone in my needs for a long time. Thank You that You care for me and that I can bring every burden to You. Help me let others in, ask for help, and receive the care You send. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

CORE FALSE BELIEF #11 · OTHER PEOPLE

“Nobody loves me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

This belief can grow from a childhood without warmth or affection, the loss of a spouse or parent, a painful breakup, or long seasons of loneliness. Depression can also color everything gray, so that even real love is hard to feel. When people feel unloved, they may withdraw, which leads to more loneliness and seems to prove the belief true.

What Scripture teaches

The Bible declares that God has loved His people with an everlasting love. John marvels at the kind of love the Father has given, that we should be called children of God. Jesus said that as the Father loved Him, so He loves us. Even if mountains are shaken, God’s loving devotion will not depart. Human love may be missing or imperfect right now, but you are loved by God fully and personally. That love can also open your eyes to the people who do care for you.

> *“Behold what manner of love the Father has given to us, that we should be called children of God. And that is what we are! The reason the world does not know us is that it did not know Him”* (1 John 3:1).

Also see

> “The LORD appeared to us in the past, saying: ‘I have loved you with an everlasting love; therefore I have drawn you with loving devotion.’” (Jeremiah 31:3).

> “As the Father has loved Me, so have I loved you. Remain in My love” (John 15:9).

> “Though the mountains may be removed and the hills may be shaken, My loving devotion will not depart from you, and My covenant of peace will not be broken, says the LORD, who has compassion on you” (Isaiah 54:10).

> “As a father has compassion on his children, so the LORD has compassion on those who fear Him” (Psalm 103:13).

Common self-statements

- No one cares about me.
- If I died, no one would miss me.
- Everyone else is loved but me.
- People are nice to me only out of obligation.
- I’m completely alone.
- Even God doesn’t love me.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralization: Using “nobody” and “never” when some people do care.
- Emotional reasoning: Believing I am unloved because I feel unloved.
- Discounting the positive: Explaining away kindness as obligation.
- Mental filter: Focusing on who doesn’t love me and overlooking who does.

Challenging questions

- Is it true that nobody loves me, or that I don’t feel loved right now?

- Who has shown me care, even in small ways?
- Am I withdrawing in ways that make love harder to find?
- Could sadness or depression be affecting how I see things?
- What does God say about His love for me?
- What is one small step toward connection?

Truth summary

> I feel unloved right now, and that is painful. But feelings are not the full truth. God has loved me with an everlasting love and calls me His child. I can look for the ways I am cared for and take small steps toward people.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Love, By God
- Loneliness
- God, All Loving
- Depression, Symptoms of
- Friendship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Love
- Depression

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Good Good Father — Chris Tomlin
God's fatherly love is deeper than human approval or achievement.

More Than Conquerors — Steven Curtis Chapman
Christ's saving work answers condemnation, shame, and fear of separation from God.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Nobody loves me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Nobody loves me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Is it true nobody loves me, or that I don't feel loved?
- ☐ Who has shown me care?
- ☐ Am I withdrawing?
- ☐ Could sadness be affecting how I see things?
- ☐ What does God say about His love?
- ☐ What small step toward connection can I take?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God has loved me with an everlasting love.
- ☐ I am called a child of God.
- ☐ Jesus loves me as the Father loves Him.
- ☐ Feeling unloved is not the same as being unloved.
- ☐ Some people do care about me.
- ☐ God's love will not depart from me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ 1 John 3:1
  "Behold what manner of love the Father has given to us, that we should be called children of God. And that is what we are! The reason the world does not know us is that it did not know Him."
- ☐ Jeremiah 31:3
  "The LORD appeared to us in the past, saying: 'I have loved you with an everlasting love; therefore I have drawn you with loving devotion.'"
- ☐ John 15:9
  "As the Father has loved Me, so have I loved you. Remain in My love."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Signs of love today: Each evening, write one sign of love or care you noticed today, from God or from a person.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, 1 John 3:1 becomes: "Linda can write: "The Father has lavished His love on me. I am called His child, and that is what I am.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Love, By God" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- ☐ Look for evidence. Write the names of people who have shown you any kindness in the last year. Ask yourself what each act says.
- ☐ Reach out once. Send one message or make one call to someone you care about this week.
- ☐ Read God's love letter. Read 1 John 3:1 and Jeremiah 31:3 each morning and say, "This is true of me."
- ☐ Get support for heavy sadness. If feeling unloved comes with deep sadness that won't lift, talk with a doctor, pastor, or counselor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie “Nobody loves me”: _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A sign of love I noticed
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Nobody loves me.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I feel so unloved and alone. Thank You that You have loved me with an everlasting love and call me Your child. Open my eyes to Your love and to the people who care about me, and give me courage to reach out. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

CORE FALSE BELIEF #12 · OTHER PEOPLE

“People cannot be trusted.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

This belief usually comes from betrayal: a parent who broke promises, abuse by someone who should have protected us, a spouse’s unfaithfulness, gossip, or being cheated. After being hurt, it makes sense to protect ourselves. But when the lesson becomes “no one can ever be trusted,” we can end up isolated, suspicious, and unable to receive the support we need.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is realistic about people. It warns that it is better to take refuge in the Lord than to trust in man, and Jesus told His followers to be shrewd as snakes and innocent as doves. Wisdom means trusting carefully, not blindly. But the Bible also calls us into community, forgiveness, and love. Our full trust belongs to God, who never fails. Because He is trustworthy, we can risk measured trust with people, give it gradually, and watch whether it is honored.

> *“When I am afraid, I put my trust in You. In God, whose word I praise— in God I trust. I will not be afraid. What can man do to me?”* (Psalm 56:3–4).

Also see

> “Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways acknowledge Him, and He will make your paths straight” (Proverbs 3:5–6).

> “But blessed is the man who trusts in the LORD, whose confidence is in Him” (Jeremiah 17:7).

> “It is better to take refuge in the LORD than to trust in man” (Psalm 118:8).

> “Behold, I am sending you out like sheep among wolves; therefore be as shrewd as snakes and as innocent as doves” (Matthew 10:16).

Common self-statements

- Everyone has a hidden agenda.
- If I trust, I’ll get hurt.
- People always let you down.
- I can only count on myself.
- Kindness is just a setup.
- It’s safer to keep everyone at arm’s length.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralization: Deciding everyone is untrustworthy because some people betrayed me.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must either trust completely or not at all.
- Mind reading: Assuming people have bad motives without evidence.
- Fortune telling: Predicting betrayal before it happens.

Challenging questions

- Who betrayed my trust, and what did I learn from it?
- Is there anyone who has proven trustworthy over time?

- Can I trust someone a little without trusting them with everything?
- What signs show that a person is trustworthy?
- What does God say about where my full trust belongs?
- What small risk of trust could I take with a safe person?

Truth summary

> Some people have betrayed me, and I am wise to be careful. But not everyone is untrustworthy. My full trust belongs to God, who never fails. Because I am secure in Him, I can offer trust to people gradually and wisely, and watch whether it is honored.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Trust
- Friendship
- Wisdom
- Forgiveness
- Refuge/Safety

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Truth

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

What You Want — Tenth Avenue North
Following God involves trust and surrender without needing control of every outcome.

Whom Shall I Fear — Chris Tomlin
God's presence provides courage without requiring a life free of difficulty.

Turn Your Eyes Upon Jesus — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn directs attention to Christ when fear or earthly concerns dominate.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People cannot be trusted"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People cannot be trusted." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who betrayed my trust, and what did I learn?
- ☐ Who has proven trustworthy?
- ☐ Can I trust someone a little?
- ☐ What signs show someone is trustworthy?
- ☐ Where does my full trust belong?
- ☐ What small risk of trust can I take?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ When I am afraid, I can trust God.
- ☐ Wisdom means trusting carefully, not never.
- ☐ Some people have proven trustworthy.
- ☐ Trust can be built step by step.
- ☐ My security rests in God.
- ☐ Forgiving does not require trusting blindly.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 56:3–4**
  "When I am afraid, I put my trust in You. In God, whose word I praise— in God I trust. I will not be afraid. What can man do to me?"
- ☐ **Proverbs 3:5–6**
  "Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways acknowledge Him, and He will make your paths straight."
- ☐ **Matthew 10:16**
  "Behold, I am sending you out like sheep among wolves; therefore be as shrewd as snakes and as innocent as doves."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Trust I tested: Each day, write one small way you trusted someone and whether that trust was honored.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 56:3–4 becomes: "David can write: "When I am afraid, I put my trust in God. With Him, I can risk trusting wisely.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Trust" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- ☐ Make a trust ladder. List small, medium, and large things you could trust someone with. Start with one small item this week.
- ☐ Name who has been faithful. Write the names of people who have kept their word to you, even in small things.
- ☐ Watch, then decide. With a new person, look for consistency between words and actions over time before deciding.
- ☐ Get help for deep wounds. If betrayal or abuse still feels raw, talk with a counselor or pastor about healing and safe boundaries.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie “People cannot be trusted”: _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Trust that was honored
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People cannot be trusted.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have been hurt by people I trusted. Thank You that You are completely trustworthy. Heal my wounds, give me wisdom to see who is safe, and courage to trust carefully again. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

CORE FALSE BELIEF #13 · OTHER PEOPLE

“My needs don’t matter.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Many people learn this in families where their needs were ignored, mocked, or treated as selfish, or where they had to take care of a parent or siblings. Some were praised for always putting others first, so they learned that having needs was bad. As adults they may say yes to everything, neglect rest and health, and feel resentful or exhausted without knowing why.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture shows a God who cares about our needs. He opens His hand and satisfies the desires of every living thing, and He promises to supply all our needs in Christ. When Elijah was exhausted and despairing, God gave him food and sleep before anything else. Jesus said to love your neighbor as yourself, which assumes that caring for yourself is normal. Serving others is good, but God never asks you to pretend you have no needs. Your needs matter to Him.

> *“And my God will supply all your needs according to His glorious riches in Christ Jesus”* (Philippians 4:19).

Also see

> “The eyes of all look to You, and You give them their food in season. You open Your hand and satisfy the desire of every living thing” (Psalm 145:15–16).

> “Then he lay down under the broom tree and fell asleep. Suddenly an angel touched him and said, ‘Get up and eat.’ And he looked around, and there by his head was a cake of bread baked over hot coals, and a jar of water. So he ate and drank and lay down again. A second time the angel of the LORD returned and touched him, saying, ‘Get up and eat, or the journey will be too much for you.’” (1 Kings 19:5–7).

> “The second is this: ‘Love your neighbor as yourself.’ No other commandment is greater than these” (Mark 12:31).

> “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest. Take My yoke upon you and learn from Me; for I am gentle and humble in heart, and you will find rest for your souls. For My yoke is easy and My burden is light” (Matthew 11:28–30).

Common self-statements

- Other people’s needs come first, always.
- It’s selfish to want anything for myself.
- I don’t want to be a bother.
- I can rest when everything else is done.
- If I say no, people will be upset.
- My feelings aren’t important.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must either meet every need of others or be selfish.
- Should statements: Telling myself I should never need anything.
- Discounting the positive: Ignoring the times my needs were met and it was good.
- Mind reading: Assuming others will be upset if I express a need.

Challenging questions

- Where did I learn that my needs don't matter?
- What needs am I ignoring right now?
- Is caring for myself really selfish?
- How did God care for Elijah when he was exhausted?
- What happens to me when I ignore my needs for too long?
- What is one need I could honestly express this week?

Truth summary

> I care about others, and that is good. But my needs matter too, to God and to the people who love me. God supplies my needs and cares about my body, rest, and feelings. I can take care of myself and still serve others.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Help
- Self-Sacrifice
- Tired
- Love, General

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Weak/Tired

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

Worn — Tenth Avenue North
Weariness can be expressed honestly while asking God for restoration.

Good Good Father — Chris Tomlin
God's fatherly love is deeper than human approval or achievement.

How Great Thou Art — Jordan Smith
This classic hymn connects God's greatness, Christ's sacrifice, and future hope.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My needs don't matter"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My needs don't matter." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn my needs don't matter?
- ☐ What needs am I ignoring?
- ☐ Is caring for myself selfish?
- ☐ How did God care for Elijah?
- ☐ What happens when I ignore my needs?
- ☐ What need can I express this week?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God will supply all my needs.
- ☐ My needs matter to God.
- ☐ Rest and care are not selfish.
- ☐ I can love others as I love myself.
- ☐ Saying no can be healthy.
- ☐ Jesus offers me rest.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Philippians 4:19**
  "And my God will supply all your needs according to His glorious riches in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ **1 Kings 19:5–7**
  "Then he lay down under the broom tree and fell asleep. Suddenly an angel touched him and said, 'Get up and eat.' And he looked around, and there by his head was a cake of bread baked over hot coals, and a jar of water. So he ate and drank and lay down again. A second time the angel of the LORD returned and touched him, saying, 'Get up and eat, or the journey will be too much for you.'"
- ☐ **Mark 12:31**
  "The second is this: 'Love your neighbor as yourself.' No other commandment is greater than these."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ A need I met: Each day, write one need you noticed in yourself and what you did about it.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Philippians 4:19 becomes: "Maria can write: "God will supply what I need. My needs matter to Him, and I can take care of them.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Tired" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- ☐ Name your needs. Write a list of what you need: rest, food, friendship, quiet, help. Circle one to address this week.
- ☐ Say one honest no. Decline one request this week that you would normally accept out of guilt. Notice what happens.
- ☐ Schedule rest. Put one hour of rest or enjoyment on your calendar and keep it like an appointment.
- ☐ Express a need. Tell one trusted person about a need you have, and let them help.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My needs don't matter": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A need I took care of
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My needs don't matter.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I have treated my needs as unimportant for so long. Thank You that You care about all of me and promise to supply what I need. Teach me to rest, to speak up, and to receive care without guilt. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.